Supply Outlook: Week 12

Consumer electronics portfolio · EMEIA · Prepared by Irueo · Built on a synthetic data. No Apple data used.

HEADLINE

Demand is running **24.7% above forecast** in the Germany's Online Store Smartphones segment over 9-12. Inventory coverage has fallen to **0.52 weeks**, leaving less than four days of demand coverage at latest weekly run rate. The immediate priority is to validate the demand increase and assess whether stock can be recollected or supply brought forward.

Key Indicators

[24.7%]
Demand vs forecast, Weeks 9-12

[0.52 wks]
Lowest inventory coverage (Germany Online Store Smartphone), Week 12

[80.2%]
Forecast accuracy, Weeks 9-12

WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

Demand begins to diverge from forecast in Week 7, and the gap widens over the following weeks. By Week 12, actual demand is 1,947 units against a forecast of 1,509. The segment's remaining inventory is 1,015 units, equivalent to approximately 0.52 weeks of demand.

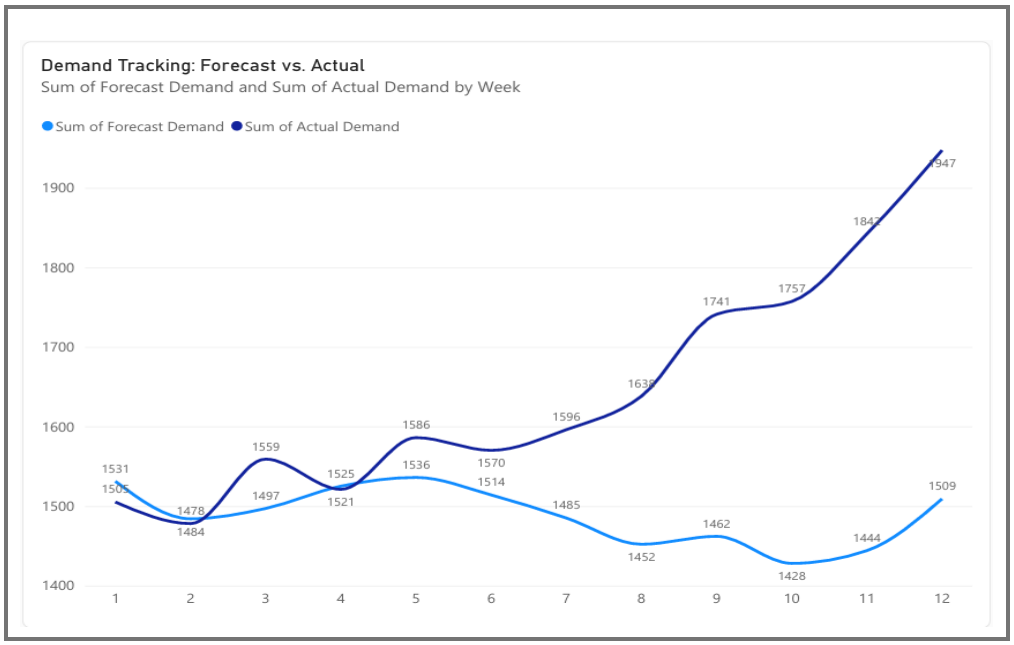


Figure 1: Germany Online Store Smartphone Segment Demand Tracking.

Note: *Figures exclude the broader retail/reseller portfolio. Forecast accuracy (1 − absolute error ÷ actual demand) was near-perfect at* ***98.4%*** *in Weeks 1–4, but dropped to* ***80.2%*** *in Weeks 9–12 due to an unforecasted demand surge.*

RISK AND ACTION BY ROUTE TO MARKET

Route	What I see	Exposure	Recommended action
Online Store	Smartphone demand materially above forecast; coverage falling	High	Validate demand driver and assess inventory reallocation / supply response

Retail	Demand broadly aligned with plan	Low	Monitor demand and coverage; check whether stock could be transferred without creating a new risk.
Reseller	Demand broadly aligned with plan	Low	Continue monitoring and confirm partner demand before changing allocations.

WHAT I NEED FROM OTHERS

Sales / Finance: Confirm whether Germany Online Store demand uplift reflects a promotion, pricing change or other commercial activity before treating the increase as structural.

Logistics: Confirm whether inventory can be reallocated from lower-risk markets and the earliest feasible transfer timing.

WHAT I AM NOT SURE ABOUT

The data shows where the demand gap occurs, but it cannot explain why it happened. Before committing to additional supply, I would check for commercial drivers, validate the next demand update and confirm the feasibility of reallocating stock.

How I got there

Method, the AI check, and the limits of this exercise

METHOD

1. Compared forecast and actual demand by week, market, channel and product to locate the divergence.
2. Compared the affected segment with the wider portfolio to assess whether the pattern was concentrated or widespread.
3. Calculated inventory coverage by dividing ending inventory by the latest week's actual demand.
4. Considered alternative explanations and separated what the dataset shows from what would need confirmation from Sales, Finance and Logistics.

AI SUGGESTED IT. I CHECKED IT.

AI tools are useful for generating ideas quickly. They are not a source of evidence. Here is how I treated what they gave me:

AI hypothesis	My check	Verdict	Effect on the recommendation
Demand has materially increased in the affected segment	Compared actual vs forecast across Weeks 7–12	Supported	Prioritise inquiries on demand uplift as the primary signal
The variance is only a one-week anomaly.	Checked variance across the affected weeks – weeks 7-12	Not supported	Treat as a persistent rather than a single-week anomaly
The issue is portfolio-wide	Compared other markets/channels/products	Not supported	Focus initial investigation on Germany Online Store Smartphone segment

LIMITS OF THIS EXERCISE

The dataset is synthetic and deliberately models a sustained demand increase in one market/channel/product segment. It is designed to practise analysis, not to represent Apple's actual operations. It does not model real promotions, supplier constraints, allocation rules or confirmed transfer lead times. The analysis identifies a risk signal; operational data and stakeholder input would be needed before making a real supply decision.

FULL WORK

SQL queries, the Excel model, the Power BI file and notes.

Why this programme

Supply Chain Graduate Programme · Cork · Irueo

WHY THIS KIND OF WORK

My Computer Science background taught me to look beyond the obvious answer: understand the data, identify what is changing, and work out what needs to happen next.

I applied that thinking to a supply-chain scenario. Demand in one segment rose above forecast while inventory coverage fell, so the key question became more than **what changed?** It was **how urgent is the risk, what could explain it, and what should the team verify before acting?**

That is what attracts me to Operations. I want to apply my analytical and problem-solving skills to real business decisions, learn from teams across Planning, Reseller Operations and Logistics and Retail Fulfilment, and develop the judgement to turn analysis into practical action.

WHAT I WOULD BRING TO THE THREE ROTATIONS

Area	What I bring	What I want to learn
Planning (SDM)	A Computer Science background, experience with SQL and structured data analysis, and a practical introduction to demand and inventory analysis through this project.	How demand forecasts, supply constraints and inventory decisions are managed across the business.
Reseller Operations	Experience clarifying requirements, communicating technical information and working with colleagues on shared delivery goals, alongside customer-facing experience.	How Apple works with resellers, understands partner needs and responds to changes in sales and product availability.
Logistics and Retail Fulfilment	A structured approach to problem-solving, experience prioritising competing tasks and an understanding of how inventory availability affects fulfilment.	How logistics constraints, stock movements and fulfilment decisions affect the customer experience.

HOW I WORK

At Ventry, I worked on backend issues and requirements in an Agile environment. I learned to investigate the problem before jumping to a solution and to consider how changes could affect the wider system.

I would bring that same discipline to Operations: understand the evidence, involve the right people, and make recommendations with clear reasoning behind them.

Thank you for reading.